VI. BJP's Vajpayee–Advani Era: 1980 to the Early 2000s

5 April 1980: Ex-Jan Sangh faction and several other leaders walk out of Janata Party and create the BJP. They have with them fifteen of the Janata Party's twenty-eight Lok Sabha MPs, all fourteen of its Rajya Sabha MPs, five former cabinet ministers, eight former ministers of state and six former chief ministers. The newly formed BJP claims it is the 'real' Janata Party, not a breakaway faction.

- Atal Bihari Vajpayee, BJP's inaugural president, says new party would fight upcoming elections on the basis of the 1977 election manifesto of the Janata Party because there was nothing wrong with the Janata Party's policies and programmes.
- L.K. Advani says there would be 'no compromise' in accepting 'Gandhism as the ideology of the new party'.
- Three member-committee tasked with drafting the BJP's new constitution: S.S. Bhandari, Ram Jethmalani and Sikandar Bakht.

21 April 1980: BJP General Secretary L.K. Advani says party 'would never sever its link with the Rashtriya Swayamsevak Sangh'.

24 April 1980: Election Commission initially sides with the BJP, gives it 'national party status' and freezes the Janata Party's election symbol for a few months until it took a final call. EC later recognised Chandra Shekhar's rump as the Janata Party in October 1980.

28–30 December 1980: Vajpayee says the BJP has embraced 'samata' (equality) as the Constitution-maker and Dalit leader Dr Ambedkar had argued for. Also invokes a new notion of 'positive secularism'.

27 December 1980: BJP Vice President Vijaya Raje Scindia publicly objects to adoption of 'socialism' as a BJP policy, says it a Western concept and that it would turn party into a 'photocopy' of the Congress.

28 December 1980: Scindia withdraws objection saying party's senior leaders had clarified that the BJP's socialism actually had 'Indian content', unlike that of Karl Marx. Says the 'socialism' the